

ALEX ● KASKASOLI

README

Driven security engineer with an offensive security background. I take the catastrophic risks of frontier AI seriously, with misuse and concentration of power chief among them, and see misalignment as a risk amplifier. Securing the research of a lab working to get ahead of misalignment is the most direct lever I can pull.

At Google DeepMind I threat modelled the production deployment of ML solutions and led the initial framework for cybersecurity safety evaluations, including running agents and vulnerable-by-design systems in isolated k8s environments on GCP.

In my previous roles as a Security Engineer and Head of Security and DevOps, I drove the design of AWS organizations from scratch, hardened k8s clusters and cloud environments, pushed GitOps practices across the engineering pool, and set up logging and monitoring stacks. I also worked alongside ISO 27001 consultants, translating compliance requirements into infrastructure-as-code policies.

Back in my pentesting days, I participated in red team engagements against large organizations, often exploiting then-nascent CI/CD and DevOps tooling for lateral movement and privilege escalation.

BLOG

My blog <https://alex.kaskaso.li> showcases personal work, talks and open-source projects, including CI/CD security thinking cited on Google's Kubernetes podcast and an AWS cloud attack nominated for PortSwigger's "best hacks of 2018".

SKILLS

Cloud & IAM Designed multi-account AWS orgs from scratch, including org-wide log centralization and security guardrails. Built bespoke IAM tooling when necessary to balance security and developer velocity.	CI/CD Built GitOps , a tool that briefly trended on GitHub, for attacking and defending CI/CD pipelines. Early GitOps and Terraform adopter, wrote and spoke on CI/CD security and pipeline hardening.	Kubernetes Researched and wrote about k8s privilege-escalation paths (including a CVE for RCE/VM escape in minikube). Ran and hardened production clusters, and wrote custom k8s controllers for bespoke needs.
Email & Comms Security Practical experience hardening collaboration and comms security (email, Slack). Built tooling to scan for email protocol misconfigurations, and blogged on the topic.	Coding Ship production tooling in Python and Go . Comfortable in JavaScript , some C and Assembly for offensive tooling and memory corruption research.	ML / AI Security Threat modelled ML deployments at Google DeepMind. A MicroMasters in stats and data science allows me to speak comfortably with researchers.

EXPERIENCE

Google DeepMind <i>Security SWE. Threat modelling of ML deployments and adversarial testing of image/text watermarks; built the initial framework for cybersecurity safety evaluations.</i>	3 years <i>London, UK</i>
Kaluza / OVO Energy <i>Tech Lead Security Engineer securing a large (100+ account) cloud organisation, automating security controls, identifying attack paths and working with engineers on remediations.</i>	2 years <i>London, UK</i>
TrueLayer <i>Security Engineer promoted to Head of DevOps and Security. Led a team of 3 to scale infrastructure, mature DevOps practices, mitigate security risks and meet regulatory compliance.</i>	1.5 years <i>London, UK</i>
MWR InfoSecurity <i>Security Consultant working on infrastructure and application security and red team simulated attacks, for clients across industries from finance to critical infrastructure.</i>	4 years <i>London, UK</i>

CERTIFICATES

OSCP, OSCE, CRT, CCT
Graduate-level MicroMasters credential in Statistics and Data Science (MITx)
BSc Ethical Hacking & Countermeasures (University of Abertay)

CONTACT

alex@kaskaso.li